RESP Multi-Brokerage Tracker: User Guide

Every tab, every column and every menu item, in plain English

The tracker is built around one idea: you type each transaction once, in the Transaction Log, and every other tab updates by itself. The only other place you type is the amber cells on Settings & Goals. Everything green is a formula: leave it alone and it will always be right.

Colour	Meaning
Amber	Your input. Type here (Settings & Goals).
Blue	A dropdown. Pick from the list (Institution, Child, Type, Currency).
White	Manual entry in the Transaction Log (date, ticker, shares, price, amount).
Green	A formula. Do not type here.

Your template link: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/10qfSKMsDM4bra3EBzD2TqgN_4aEdz8ev0ezBuFIbNjo/copy (opens Make a copy).

THE MAPLESHEET MENU

Menu item	What it does
Build / Rebuild All Tabs	Builds every tab. Safe to run again: it keeps your Settings inputs and Transaction Log rows.
Load Sample Data	Fills the Transaction Log with a sample family: two children, Emma (born 2015) and Liam (born 2019), with RESPs at 3 institutions. Replaces anything in the log and the children in Settings.
Clear Sample Data	Empties the Transaction Log. Formulas, dropdowns and Settings stay.
Rebuild Dashboard Charts	Redraws the two Main Dashboard charts if one goes blank.
About	Shows the version.

First time you use the menu. Google shows an "Authorization required" box. Click Continue, choose your Google account, then Advanced and Allow. The script only works inside your own copy of the sheet.

1. SETTINGS & GOALS: SET UP ONCE, UPDATE EACH JANUARY

Cell	What to enter	Where to find it
B5 to B7	Your name, province and Active Year (the year you are tracking).	Change B7 every January.
B8	Year you opened your OLDEST RESP.	Your first RESP statement. Sets the 31-year and 35-year dates.
B9	Family or Individual plan.	Your RESP application or statement.
B13 to B20	Up to 8 institutions. Leave a slot blank to hide it.	Use the same name every time in the Transaction Log.
B25 to E25	Each child's name (up to 4). These fill the Child dropdown.	Leave a column blank if you have fewer children.
B26 to E26	Each child's birth year.	Sets grant room, age and the last CESG year.
B27 to E27	Contributions made for the child BEFORE the Active Year, by anyone, at any institution.	Add up your RESP statements. Withdrawals do not reduce it.

Cell	What to enter	Where to find it
B28 to E28	CESG received for the child BEFORE the Active Year (basic + additional).	Your RESP statements, or ask your RESP provider.
B49 to B52	Contribution goal, education savings goal, dividend goal and the year your first child starts school.	Your own plan.
B55 to B56	Default currency and an optional USD/CAD rate.	Leave B56 blank to use the live rate.

B31 to B35 hold the numbers the formulas use: the $50,000 lifetime limit, the 20% CESG rate, $500 of grant room a year, $1,000 maximum CESG in one year and the $7,200 lifetime CESG. They are set by law and filled in for you. The rest of the tab is a quick RESP reference and two checklists, one for December and one for January.

2. TRANSACTION LOG: THE ONLY TAB YOU TYPE INTO

One row per transaction, starting on row 4. Never delete old rows: your average cost and history depend on them.

Col	Column	What to enter
A	Date	The transaction date (yyyy-mm-dd).
B	Year	Automatic.
C	Institution	Dropdown from Settings B13:B20.
D	Child	Dropdown from Settings B25:E25. Pick it on every Contribution, CESG, CLB, Provincial Grant and EAP row. Leave it blank for buys, sells and dividends.
E	Type	Dropdown, see the table below.
F	Ticker	With the exchange prefix: TSE:XEQT, TSE:VGRO, NYSE:KO. Leave blank for contributions and grants.
G	Description	Anything that helps you remember.
H	Currency	CAD or USD.
I	Shares / Units	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
J	Price / Share	For Buy, Sell and DRIP.
K	Commission	Optional.
L	Amt (Original)	The total in the original currency. For a buy: shares x price + commission.
M	FX Rate	Automatic: 1 for CAD, live USD/CAD (or your override) for USD.
N	Amt (CAD)	Automatic. Every dashboard adds up this column.

Type	Use it for	Counts toward $50,000?
Contribution	Money you (or anyone) put in for a child.	Yes
CESG	Canada Education Savings Grant deposits (basic and additional).	No
CLB	Canada Learning Bond deposits.	No
Provincial Grant	BC grant (BCTESG) or Quebec grant (QESI).	No
Buy / Sell / DRIP	Investments bought, sold, or bought with reinvested dividends.	No
Dividend / Fee	Cash dividends received, account or trading fees.	No
Transfer Out / Transfer In	A DIRECT transfer of an RESP between institutions. Log both sides.	No

Type	Use it for	Counts toward $50,000?
EAP	Educational Assistance Payment to the student: grants and growth. Taxed to the student.	Never gives room back
PSE Withdrawal	Your contributions back, tax-free, while the child is in school.	Never gives room back
Non-Educational Withdrawal	Contributions taken out when no child is in school. Grants may have to be repaid.	Never gives room back
AIP / Grant Repayment	Accumulated Income Payment, or grants returned to the government when a plan closes.	Never gives room back

Moving an RESP to another institution? Ask the receiving institution for a direct RESP-to-RESP transfer and log it as Transfer Out and Transfer In. If you withdraw and re-deposit instead, the money counts again against the $50,000 limit and grants may have to be repaid.

3. RESP PORTFOLIO

Fully automatic. Every ticker you have bought appears once, combined across all institutions: shares held, average cost, cost basis (ACB), live price in CAD (GOOGLEFINANCE, US prices converted with the live rate), market value, gain/loss and dividends received. A hidden helper block splits your shares by institution so the dashboards can show each one separately. Investments are tracked per institution, not per child, because most families invest one pot for all their children.

4. MAIN DASHBOARD

Section	What it shows
Institution cards	One column per institution plus a Combined Total: market value, cost basis, gain/loss, contributions all time, contributions this year, grants received this year and withdrawals this year. "This year" means the Active Year in Settings B7.
Per-child block	One column per child plus All Children. See the table below.
Message line	Red if any child is over the $50,000 limit. Otherwise how much more you need to contribute, across all your children, to collect every dollar of this year's CESG.
RESP Timeline & Education Goal	Year your first RESP opened, last year you can contribute (31 years), the year the plan must close (35 years), when your first child starts school, your savings goal and progress.
Last 5 transactions	Your most recent entries, with the child, to check nothing is missing.
Charts	Market value by institution, and CESG received vs left of $7,200 for each child.

Per-child row	How it is worked out
Age on Dec 31	Active Year minus birth year. CESG stops after the year the child turns 17.
Contributions this year	Every Contribution row for the child in the Active Year, at every institution.
Lifetime contributions / room left	Settings row 27 plus this year, measured against $50,000.
Max CESG you can get this year	The smallest of: $1,000; $500 for every year since birth minus CESG already received; and $7,200 minus CESG already received.
CESG earned by this year's contributions	20% of this year's contributions, up to the maximum above.
Contribute this much more	What it still takes, before December 31, to earn the maximum. $0 means you are done.
CESG received / left	Settings row 28 plus CESG rows this year, against $7,200, with a progress bar.

Per-child row	How it is worked out
Status	Over $50,000, no CESG (18+), $7,200 reached, check the 16–17 rule, an amount still to contribute, or CESG maxed.

5. INSTITUTION DASHBOARD

The same cards side by side for up to 8 institutions (market value, ACB, gain/loss, contributions, grants and dividends this year), with the full per-child block underneath. Use it to see which RESP is really carrying your returns.

6. DIVIDEND TRACKER

Eight summary cards (all-time and this-year dividends and DRIP, monthly average, full-year estimate, your goal and progress), Section A month by month against your monthly target, Section B every dividend and DRIP with its institution, and Section C a per-ticker summary with an annual run rate. US dividends are entered after the 15% US withholding tax, which RESPs are not exempt from.

7. RESP CRA RULES

Every rule that matters when you hold RESPs at more than one institution, as colour-coded cards: red for costly mistakes, amber for limits and deadlines, green for benefits. The RESP Government Rules PDF explains each one in more detail.

EVERY JANUARY

1. **Make a copy (optional)**
   File, Make a copy, named for the new year. Or keep one file for every year: the log holds all history.
2. **Change the Active Year**
   Settings B7, for example 2026 to 2027. All "this year" numbers switch to the new year.
3. **Update each child's contributions**
   Settings row 27: add what was contributed for each child last year.
4. **Update each child's CESG**
   Settings row 28: add the CESG each child received last year.

TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem	Fix
A price shows $0.00	Check the ticker prefix: TSE: for Toronto, NYSE: or NASDAQ: for US, NEO: for Cboe Canada. GOOGLEFINANCE can also pause for a few minutes.
A child shows $0 contributions	The Child column (D) is blank on that row, or the name does not match Settings exactly.
A transaction is missing from a dashboard	Check the Institution name matches Settings exactly, the Type is from the dropdown, and the date is a real date.
"This year" numbers are $0	Settings B7 (Active Year) does not match the year of your transactions.
Max CESG looks wrong	Check the birth year (row 26) and CESG received before this year (row 28). Additional CESG also counts toward $7,200, so your RESP statement is the final word.
A chart is blank	MapleSheet menu, Rebuild Dashboard Charts.

Problem	Fix
Something broke	MapleSheet menu, Build / Rebuild All Tabs. Your inputs and transactions are kept.

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice. Rules summarized for 2026 from canada.ca (Registered Education Savings Plans, Canada Education Savings Grant, Canada Learning Bond). Always confirm your own numbers with your RESP provider. Questions: hello@maplesheet.ca